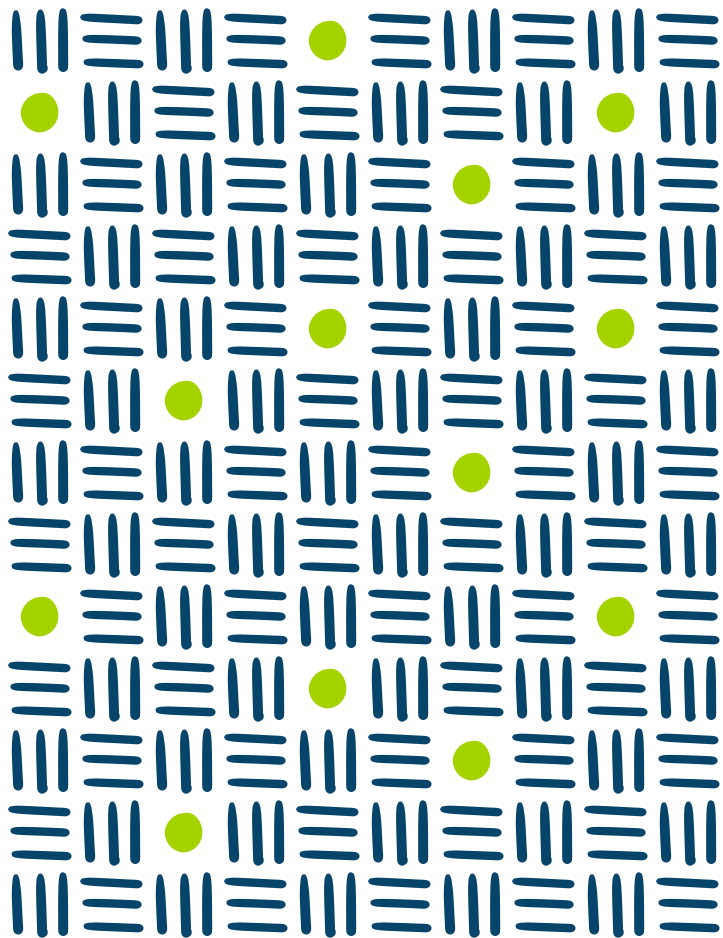




Welfare States

Faye Chang



Literature Review pt. 1

Definition: a model of social provision in which the state establishes a robust net of social programmes to provide for those that are unable to meet their own needs sufficiently.

Features: transfer programmes, publicly provided goods (health, education, transport, etc), progressive and redistributive taxation, regulation in labour and goods market (*Alesina and Glaeser, 2004*)

Attitudes to welfare

individual-level support:

- shaped by **self-interest** (*Férrandez and Jaime-Casfillo, 2018; Margalit and Raviv, 2024*)
- changes to **personal circumstance** significantly shift preferences (*O'Grady, 2017*)
- viewed in **relative terms** (*Burgoon, Baute and van Norte, 2022; Baldwin and Huber, 2010*)
- in terms of **wealth**, not income (*Jensen and Wiedemann, 2023*)

'**policy-feedback**' effect:

- more progressive tax system makes redistribution salient (*Baremendi and Rehm, 2016*)
- more extensive benefits and protections system decreases demand for such reform (*Gringrich and Ansell, 2012*).

Literature Review pt. 2

Attitudes to welfare (cont.)

moderated through understandings of **'deservingness'**:

- **shifting language** from 'vagrants' to 'the unemployed' (*Scheve and Serlin, 2023*)
- **distributive justice principles** makes public support more likely (*Findor et al., 2023*)
- **education** (*MacArthur, 2021*) and **homeownership** (*Han and Yong Kwon, 2023*) have opposing impacts on sympathy towards welfare provision

demographic **distribution** + **institutional** features:

- high **correlation** of income and risk decreases public support (*Rehm, Hacker, and Schlesinger, 2012*)
- left-wing party voters are **geographically clustered**, and therefore unlikely to win in **majoritarian** systems (*O'Grady and Wiedemann, 2024*)
- democracy ≠ redistributive policies in **'captured democracies'**, **neoliberal policy regimes**, or **polarised publics** (*Kang and Seo, 2023; Lindqvist and Östling, 2010*)



Do welfare states depend mainly on social solidarity?



‘Depend mainly’

Difficulty of comparing substantive impacts across units and sources

Baldwin and Huber, 2010 suggest only between-group income inequality matters, not ethnolinguistic fractionalisation or cultural fractionalisation

- Only measures impact on public goods provision
- Income inequality = limited view of economic inequality, results not definitive



‘Social solidarity’

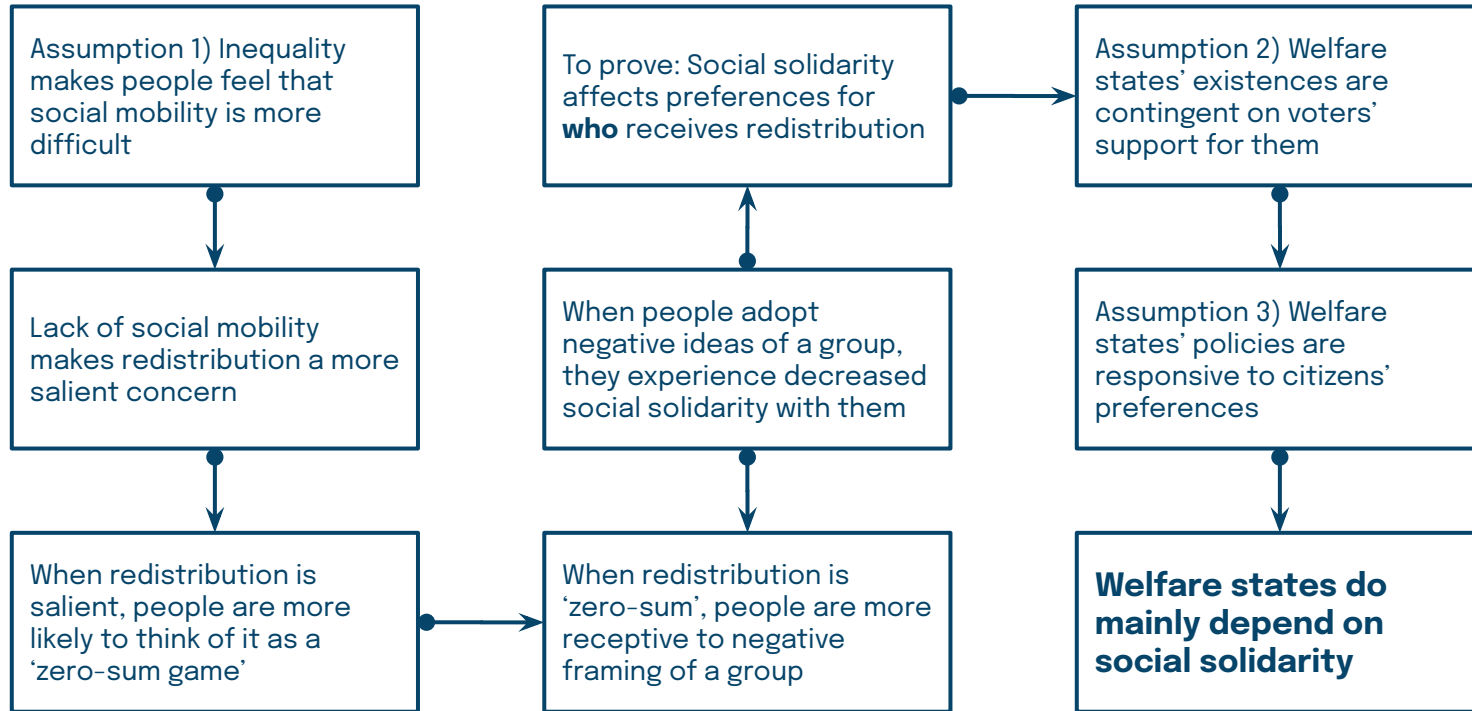
Definition

1. Shared aspect of identity: regional, ethnic, class-based
2. Recognition of shared aspect
3. Sense of favourability towards in-group members

Determining between sociotropic feeling or self-interest w/ perception of group membership → out of the scope

Will focus on **native vs immigrant** solidarity

Theoretical framework



Testable Hypotheses

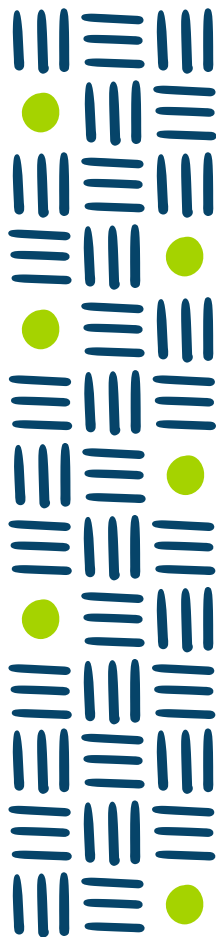
1. Negative framing of out-group decreases social solidarity

Provides a causal mechanism for changes in social solidarity

2. Decreased social solidarity with out-group members increases preferences for redistribution to in-group members

3. Decreased social solidarity with out-group members decreases preferences for redistribution to them





Methodology

Data sources: Survey experiments (conservative-estimate cases)

- H1: nationally representative survey of 4158 German citizens
- H2 and H3: nationally representative survey of 1275 Italian citizens

Independent variable(s): type of treatment (H1 / H2 and H3)

1. Negative frame on immigrants / Economic inequality treatment
2. Positive frame on immigrants / Poverty treatment
3. Control group

Dependent variable(s):

- Support for welfare generally
- Support for welfare for low-income immigrants

Use of survey **experiments** means that control variables are not necessary. Assuming there is no selection bias, the randomised assignment of treatment will produce results which already control for demographic individual-level and national-level variables

Empirical results

Table 1 The government should guarantee that immigrants have the same rights to social benefits as German citizens

	Negative frame	Positive frame	Control group
Strongly Disagree	23.7	21.4	21.0
Disagree	26.6	26.2	28.7
Neither agree nor disagree	28.0	26.3	26.1
Agree	16.5	20.4	18.7
Strongly Agree	5.2	5.6	5.5

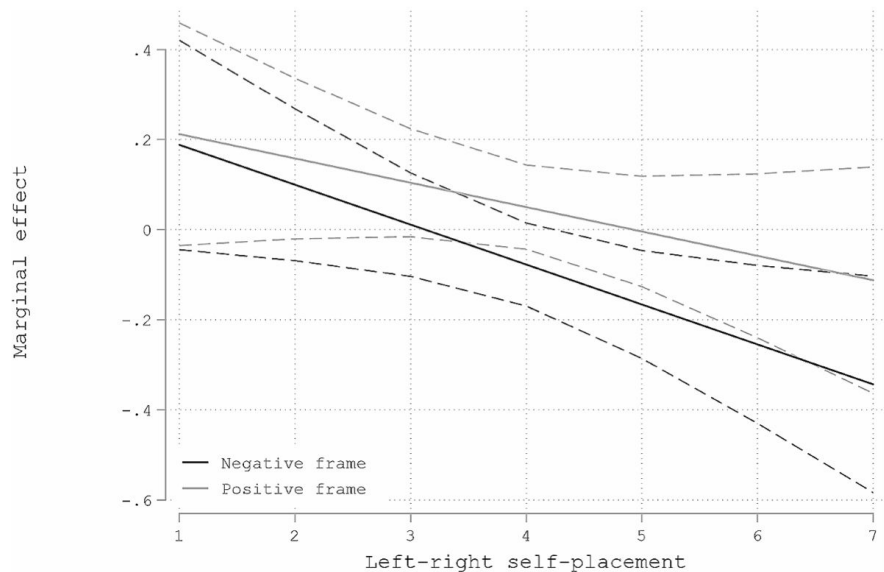


Fig. 3 The marginal effect of framing on support for equal access to welfare for immigrants, conditional on an individual's ideological self-placement

Framing does change support for immigrants

Negative framing reduces social solidarity with immigrants

This effect is magnified by respondents' existing ideological position

'Boomerang' effect for extremist voters: Die Linke and AfD



Empirical results

	Support for											
	Low-income natives						Low-income immigrants					
	OLS		Logistic		Ordered logistic		OLS		Logistic		Ordered logistic	
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Inequality	0.07* (0.03)	0.09* (0.04)	0.29* (0.14)	0.39* (0.15)	0.23* (0.13)	0.31* (0.14)	-0.01 (0.03)	-0.02 (0.03)	-0.06 (0.14)	-0.07 (0.17)	-0.00 (0.12)	-0.07 (0.14)
Poverty	0.02 (0.03)	0.04 (0.04)	0.10 (0.14)	0.17 (0.15)	0.05 (0.13)	0.09 (0.14)	0.02 (0.03)	-0.01 (0.03)	0.09 (0.15)	-0.05 (0.17)	0.04 (0.12)	-0.15 (0.14)
Covariates	No	Yes	No	Yes	No	Yes	No	Yes	No	Yes	No	Yes
Control mean	0.42	0.42	0.42	0.42	4.07	4.07	0.08	0.08	0.08	0.08	2.42	2.42
Observations	1,273	1,098	1,273	1,098	1,273	1,098	1,273	1,098	1,273	1,098	1,273	1,098
R ²	0.004	0.05	-	-	-	-	0.001	0.12	-	-	-	-
AIC	-	-	1,752.3	1,492.7	3,221.7	2,753.7	-	-	1,645.1	1,309.5	3,867.7	3,207.2

Support for redistribution

To low-income natives

48.6%

To low-income immigrants

9.9%

Based off of 'inequality' treatment group



Potential issues with the theory

Issues	Is it a problem for the theory?	Source
Uniqueness of effect to immigrant - non natives	Holds for class-based solidarity, as a result of uneven income distributions	Lupu and Pontusson, 2011
Own economic outlook	No evidence that own economic outlook moderates effect of frames Variables: household income, social grade, perceptions of job security, expectations for financial position	Avdagic and Savage, 2019
Own economic position	Rich and poor respondents demonstrate similar preferences under treatment	Magni, 2020
Non-Western countries	Holds for government provision of public goods to co-ethnics in Africa	Beiser-McGrath et al., 2021





Summary of results

Feelings of social solidarity, which varies depending on factors such as inequality, matter for people's preferences about who the welfare state provides for

Hypothesis 1 and Hypothesis 3 are explicitly supported

Hypothesis 2 is implicitly supported, but would need further research

Experimental results are supported by cross-national survey results (external validity)

	Welfare support for people in need			Welfare support for immigrants		
	1	2	3	4	5	6
Inequality	1.489** (0.518)	1.205* (0.522)	1.158* (0.517)	-1.083* (0.528)	-1.228* (0.528)	-1.033* (0.517)

Magni, 2020: higher inequality leads to decreased support for welfare for immigrants

Some level of evidence that the mechanism of 'social solidarity' is based on genuine sociotropic feeling, and not individual self-interest

Further research required into Assumption 2) and Assumption 3) on the links between people's preferences about the welfare state and government reaction